

# 02-ONNX

## 1 ONNX (Open Neural Network Exchange)

**Document Version:** 1.0

**Generated:** December 4, 2025

**Standard Version:** ONNX 1.16

**Status:** Widely Adopted Industry Standard

---

### 1.1 Table of Contents

1. [Overview](#)
  2. [Authoritative References](#)
  3. [Format Structure](#)
  4. [Procedural Use-Cases](#)
  5. [ONNX Operators](#)
  6. [Examples](#)
  7. [Tools & Ecosystem](#)
  8. [Best Practices](#)
  9. [References](#)
- 

### 1.2 Overview

**ONNX (Open Neural Network Exchange)** is an open format designed to represent machine learning models, enabling interoperability between different frameworks. ONNX defines a common computational graph representation and a set of standard operators that can be implemented by various ML frameworks and runtime engines.

#### 1.2.1 Key Features

- **Framework Interoperability:** Train in PyTorch, deploy in TensorFlow or vice versa
- **Hardware Optimization:** Optimized runtimes for CPUs, GPUs, and specialized accelerators
- **Versioned Operator Sets:** Backward-compatible evolution of operations
- **Extensible:** Custom operators and model metadata support
- **Binary Format:** Efficient serialization using Protocol Buffers

#### 1.2.2 Primary Use Cases

1. **Model Export:** Export trained models from ML frameworks
  2. **Cross-Framework Deployment:** Use models across different ecosystems
  3. **Optimization:** Apply framework-agnostic optimizations
  4. **Production Serving:** Deploy to optimized inference engines
  5. **Model Sharing:** Distribute pre-trained models in a universal format
- 

### 1.3 Authoritative References

#### 1.3.1 Official Specifications

- **ONNX GitHub Repository:** <https://github.com/onnx/onnx>
- **ONNX Specification:** <https://github.com/onnx/onnx/blob/main/docs/IR.md>
- **Operator Schemas:** <https://github.com/onnx/onnx/blob/main/docs/Operators.md>
- **ONNX Model Zoo:** <https://github.com/onnx/models>

#### 1.3.2 Standards Bodies

- **Linux Foundation AI & Data:** Hosts ONNX project
- **ONNX Steering Committee:** Governance and roadmap
- **Website:** <https://onnx.ai/>

### 1.3.3 Version History

- **ONNX 1.0** (2017): Initial release
  - **ONNX 1.5** (2019): Added training support
  - **ONNX 1.10** (2021): Enhanced operator coverage
  - **ONNX 1.16** (2024): Latest stable release
- 

## 1.4 Format Structure

ONNX models are serialized using **Protocol Buffers** (protobuf), a language-neutral, platform-neutral extensible mechanism for serializing structured data.

### 1.4.1 Core Entities

```
graph TD
    A[ModelProto] --> B[GraphProto]
    B --> C[NodeProto]
    B --> D[TensorProto]
    B --> E[ValueInfoProto]
    C --> F[AttributeProto]
    A --> G[OpSetImport]
    A --> H[MetadataProto]
```

#### 1.4.2 1. ModelProto (Top-Level)

**Role:** Root container for the entire model.

**Key Attributes:** - **ir\_version** : ONNX IR version (currently 8) - **opset\_import** : Imported operator sets with versions - **producer\_name** : Framework that created the model (e.g., “pytorch”, “tensorflow”) - **producer\_version** : Version of the producing framework - **graph** : The main computational graph (GraphProto) - **metadata\_props** : Key-value pairs for custom metadata

**Impact:** Defines compatibility and provenance of the model.

**Protobuf Definition:**

```
message ModelProto {
    optional int64 ir_version = 1;
    repeated OperatorSetIdProto opset_import = 8;
    optional string producer_name = 2;
    optional string producer_version = 3;
    optional string domain = 4;
    optional int64 model_version = 5;
    optional string doc_string = 6;
    optional GraphProto graph = 7;
    repeated StringStringEntryProto metadata_props = 14;
}
```

#### 1.4.3 2. GraphProto (Computational Graph)

**Role:** Represents the computational graph structure.

**Key Attributes:** - **node** : List of computation nodes (operations) - **initializer** : Pre-initialized tensor values (weights, biases) - **input** : Graph input specifications - **output** : Graph output specifications - **value\_info** : Intermediate tensor type information

**Impact:** Defines the actual computation flow and data transformations.

**Protobuf Definition:**

```

message GraphProto {
  repeated NodeProto node = 1;
  optional string name = 2;
  repeated TensorProto initializer = 5;
  optional string doc_string = 10;
  repeated ValueInfoProto input = 11;
  repeated ValueInfoProto output = 12;
  repeated ValueInfoProto value_info = 13;
}

```

### 1.4.4 3. NodeProto (Operator Node)

**Role:** Represents a single operation in the graph.

**Key Attributes:** - `op_type` : Operator name (e.g., “Conv”, “MatMul”, “Relu”) - `input` : List of input tensor names - `output` : List of output tensor names - `attribute` : Operator-specific parameters - `domain` : Namespace for custom operators (empty for standard ops)

**Impact:** Defines individual computations and their connectivity.

**Protobuf Definition:**

```

message NodeProto {
  repeated string input = 1;
  repeated string output = 2;
  optional string name = 3;
  optional string op_type = 4;
  optional string domain = 7;
  repeated AttributeProto attribute = 5;
  optional string doc_string = 6;
}

```

### 1.4.5 4. TensorProto (Tensor Data)

**Role:** Stores tensor data (weights, constants).

**Key Attributes:** - `dims` : Shape of the tensor - `data_type` : Element data type (FLOAT, INT64, etc.) - `raw_data` : Binary blob of tensor data - `float_data`, `int64_data`, etc.: Type-specific data fields

**Impact:** Contains model parameters and constants.

**Protobuf Definition:**

```

message TensorProto {
  repeated int64 dims = 1;
  optional int32 data_type = 2;

  repeated float float_data = 4 [packed = true];
  repeated int32 int32_data = 5 [packed = true];
  repeated int64 int64_data = 7 [packed = true];
  optional bytes raw_data = 9;

  optional string name = 8;
  optional string doc_string = 12;
}

```

### 1.4.6 5. ValueInfoProto (Tensor Metadata)

**Role:** Describes tensor types and shapes.

**Key Attributes:** - `name` : Tensor identifier - `type` : Type information (tensor shape and element type)

**Impact:** Enables type checking and optimization.

### 1.4.7 6. AttributeProto (Operator Parameters)

**Role:** Stores operator-specific configuration.

**Key Attributes:** - `name` : Parameter name (e.g., “kernel\_shape”, “strides”) - `type` : Attribute type (INT, FLOAT, STRING, TENSOR, etc.)  
- Value fields: `i`, `f`, `s`, `t`, etc. depending on type

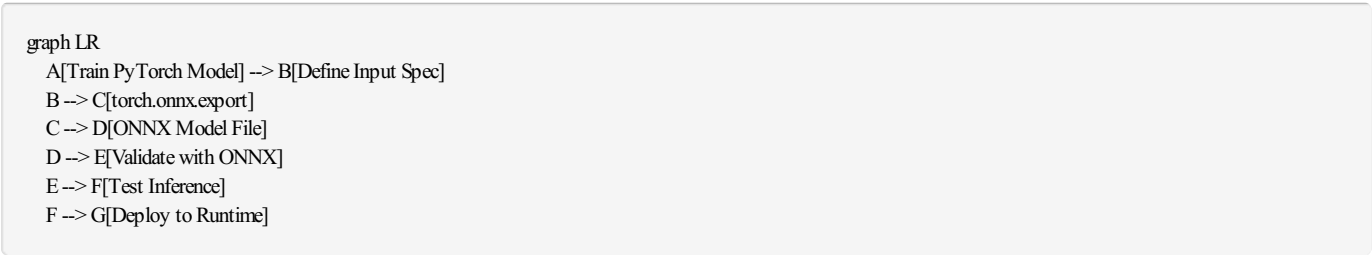
**Impact:** Configures operator behavior.

## 1.5 Procedural Use-Cases

### 1.5.1 Use-Case 1: PyTorch to ONNX Export

**Goal:** Export a trained PyTorch model to ONNX format for deployment.

**Workflow:**



**Step-by-Step Procedure:**

#### 1. Train the Model:

```
import torch
import torch.nn as nn

class SimpleNet(nn.Module):
    def __init__(self):
        super().__init__()
        self.conv1 = nn.Conv2d(3, 64, kernel_size=3, padding=1)
        self.relu = nn.ReLU()
        self.fc = nn.Linear(64 * 32 * 32, 10)

    def forward(self, x):
        x = self.relu(self.conv1(x))
        x = x.view(x.size(0), -1)
        x = self.fc(x)
        return x

model = SimpleNet()
# ... training code ...
```

#### 2. Export to ONNX:

```

import torch.onnx

# Prepare dummy input matching expected shape
dummy_input = torch.randn(1, 3, 32, 32)

# Export
torch.onnx.export(
    model,                # Model to export
    dummy_input,          # Example input
    "simplenet.onnx",     # Output file
    export_params=True,   # Store trained weights
    opset_version=15,     # ONNX opset version
    do_constant_folding=True, # Optimize constants
    input_names=['input'], # Input tensor names
    output_names=['output'], # Output tensor names
    dynamic_axes={        # Variable batch size
        'input': {0: 'batch_size'},
        'output': {0: 'batch_size'}
    }
)

```

### 3. Validate:

```

import onnx

# Load and check model
onnx_model = onnx.load("simplenet.onnx")
onnx.checker.check_model(onnx_model)
print("ONNX model is valid!")

# Print model info
print(onnx.helper.printable_graph(onnx_model.graph))

```

### 4. Test Inference:

```

import onnxruntime as ort
import numpy as np

# Load ONNX model
session = ort.InferenceSession("simplenet.onnx")

# Prepare input
input_data = np.random.randn(1, 3, 32, 32).astype(np.float32)

# Run inference
outputs = session.run(
    None, # Return all outputs
    {"input": input_data}
)

print("Output shape:", outputs[0].shape)

```

## 1.5.2 Use-Case 2: TensorFlow to ONNX Conversion

**Goal:** Convert a TensorFlow SavedModel to ONNX.

**Workflow:**

graph LR

A[TensorFlow SavedModel] --> B[tf2onnx Converter]

B --> C[ONNX Model]

C --> D[Optimize with ONNX Optimizer]

D --> E[Deploy]

## Procedure:

### 1. Save TensorFlow Model:

```
import tensorflow as tf

# Create and train model
model = tf.keras.Sequential([
    tf.keras.layers.Conv2D(32, 3, activation='relu', input_shape=(28, 28, 1)),
    tf.keras.layers.Flatten(),
    tf.keras.layers.Dense(10, activation='softmax')
])

# Train model...
# model.fit(...)

# Save as SavedModel
model.save('tf_model_saved')
```

### 2. Convert to ONNX:

```
python -m tf2onnx.convert \
    --saved-model tf_model_saved \
    --output model.onnx \
    --opset 15
```

### 3. Optimize:

```
import onnx
from onnxoptimizer import optimize

# Load model
model = onnx.load("model.onnx")

# Apply optimizations
optimized_model = optimize(model, passes=[
    'eliminate_identity',
    'eliminate_nop_transpose',
    'fuse_bn_into_conv',
    'fuse_consecutive_transposes'
])

# Save optimized model
onnx.save(optimized_model, "model_optimized.onnx")
```

## 1.5.3 Use-Case 3: Model Optimization Pipeline

**Goal:** Optimize ONNX model for inference performance.

**Workflow:**

```
graph TD
    A[Original ONNX Model] --> B[Graph Optimization]
    B --> C[Quantization]
    C --> D[Constant Folding]
    D --> E[Optimized Model]
    E --> F{Performance Test}
    F -->|Good| G[Deploy]
    F -->|Poor| H[Adjust Parameters]
    H --> B
```

Optimization Techniques:

1. Graph Optimization:

```
from onnxruntime.transformers import optimizer

# Optimize transformer models
optimized_model = optimizer.optimize_model(
    "model.onnx",
    model_type='bert',
    num_heads=12,
    hidden_size=768
)
optimized_model.save_model_to_file("model_optimized.onnx")
```

2. Quantization (INT8):

```
import onnxruntime.quantization as quantization

# Dynamic quantization
quantization.quantize_dynamic(
    "model.onnx",
    "model_quantized.onnx",
    weight_type=quantization.QuantType.QInt8
)

# Static quantization (requires calibration data)
def calibration_data_reader():
    # Yield calibration batches
    for i in range(100):
        yield {"input": np.random.randn(1, 3, 224, 224).astype(np.float32)}

quantization.quantize_static(
    "model.onnx",
    "model_int8.onnx",
    calibration_data_reader()
)
```

1.6 ONNX Operators

ONNX defines a comprehensive set of standard operators covering various neural network operations.

1.6.1 Operator Categories

| Category           | Operators                                  | Use Cases              |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| Neural Network     | Conv, MaxPool, BatchNormalization, Dropout | CNN layers             |
| Math               | Add, Sub, Mul, Div, MatMul, Gemm           | Arithmetic operations  |
| Activation         | Relu, Sigmoid, Tanh, Softmax, Gelu         | Non-linearities        |
| Reduction          | ReduceMean, ReduceSum, ArgMax, ArgMin      | Aggregations           |
| Shape Manipulation | Reshape, Transpose, Concat, Split          | Tensor transformations |

| Category         | Operators                    | Use Cases          |
|------------------|------------------------------|--------------------|
| Logical          | And, Or, Not, Equal, Greater | Boolean operations |
| RNN              | LSTM, GRU, RNN               | Recurrent networks |
| Object Detection | NMS, RoiAlign                | Vision tasks       |

## 1.6.2 Key Operators in Detail

### 1.6.2.1 Conv (Convolution)

**Purpose:** 2D convolutional operation for image processing.

**Attributes:** - `kernel_shape` : Filter dimensions [height, width] - `strides` : Step size [stride\_h, stride\_w] - `pads` : Padding [top, left, bottom, right] - `dilations` : Dilation factors - `group` : Number of groups (for grouped convolutions)

**Inputs:** 1. `X` : Input tensor [N, C\_in, H, W] 2. `W` : Weight tensor [C\_out, C\_in/group, kernel\_h, kernel\_w] 3. `B` : Optional bias [C\_out]

**Outputs:** 1. `Y` : Output tensor [N, C\_out, H\_out, W\_out]

**Example Node:**

```
conv_node = onnx.helper.make_node(
    'Conv',
    inputs=['X', 'W', 'B'],
    outputs=['Y'],
    kernel_shape=[3, 3],
    pads=[1, 1, 1, 1],
    strides=[1, 1]
)
```

### 1.6.2.2 MatMul (Matrix Multiplication)

**Purpose:** General matrix multiplication.

**Inputs:** 1. `A` : Matrix [M, K] 2. `B` : Matrix [K, N]

**Outputs:** 1. `Y` : Result [M, N]

**Example:**

```
matmul_node = onnx.helper.make_node(
    'MatMul',
    inputs=['A', 'B'],
    outputs=['Y']
)
```

### 1.6.2.3 Softmax

**Purpose:** Softmax activation for classification.

**Attributes:** - `axis` : Dimension to apply softmax (default: -1)

**Formula:**  $\text{softmax}(x_i) = \frac{e^{x_i}}{\sum_j e^{x_j}}$

**Example:**



```
softmax_node = onnx.helper.make_node(
    'Softmax',
    inputs=['X'],
    outputs=['Y'],
    axis=1
)
```

## 1.7 Examples

### 1.7.1 Example 1: Complete ONNX Model (Pseudo-Binary Structure)

**Logical Structure** (for binary ONNX file):

```
ModelProto {
  ir_version: 8
  producer_name: "pytorch"
  producer_version: "2.0.0"
  opset_import {
    domain: ""
    version: 15
  }
  graph: GraphProto {
    name: "simple_classifier"
    node: [
      NodeProto {
        input: ["input", "conv_weight", "conv_bias"]
        output: ["conv_output"]
        op_type: "Conv"
        attribute: [
          {name: "kernel_shape", ints: [3, 3]},
          {name: "strides", ints: [1, 1]}
        ]
      },
      NodeProto {
        input: ["conv_output"]
        output: ["relu_output"]
        op_type: "Relu"
      },
      NodeProto {
        input: ["relu_output", "fc_weight", "fc_bias"]
        output: ["logits"]
        op_type: "Gemm"
      },
      NodeProto {
        input: ["logits"]
        output: ["output"]
        op_type: "Softmax"
        attribute: [{name: "axis", i: 1}]
      }
    ]
    initializer: [
      TensorProto {
        name: "conv_weight"
        dims: [64, 3, 3, 3]
        data_type: FLOAT
        raw_data: <binary blob>
      },
      TensorProto {
        name: "conv_bias"
        dims: [64]
        data_type: FLOAT
        raw_data: <binary blob>
      },
      TensorProto {
        name: "fc_weight"
        dims: [10, 64]
        data_type: FLOAT
        raw_data: <binary blob>
      },
      TensorProto {
        name: "fc_bias"
        dims: [10]
        data_type: FLOAT
        raw_data: <binary blob>
      }
    ]
  }
}
```

```

    data_type: FLOAT
    raw_data: <binary blob>
  },
  TensorProto {
    name: "fc_bias"
    dims: [10]
    data_type: FLOAT
    raw_data: <binary blob>
  }
]
input: [
  ValueInfoProto {
    name: "input"
    type: {
      tensor_type: {
        elem_type: FLOAT
        shape: {dim: [{dim_param: "batch"}, {dim_value: 3}, {dim_value: 32}, {dim_value: 32}]}
      }
    }
  }
]
output: [
  ValueInfoProto {
    name: "output"
    type: {
      tensor_type: {
        elem_type: FLOAT
        shape: {dim: [{dim_param: "batch"}, {dim_value: 10}]}
      }
    }
  }
]
}

```

## 1.7.2 Example 2: Creating ONNX Model Programmatically

**Python Code** (actual implementation):

```

import onnx
from onnx import helper, TensorProto
import numpy as np

# Create input/output value info
input_info = helper.make_tensor_value_info(
    'input', TensorProto.FLOAT, [1, 3, 224, 224]
)
output_info = helper.make_tensor_value_info(
    'output', TensorProto.FLOAT, [1, 1000]
)

# Create weight tensors
conv_weight = np.random.randn(64, 3, 7, 7).astype(np.float32)
conv_weight_tensor = helper.make_tensor(
    'conv_weight',
    TensorProto.FLOAT,
    conv_weight.shape,
    conv_weight.flatten()
)

fc_weight = np.random.randn(1000, 64).astype(np.float32)
fc_weight_tensor = helper.make_tensor(
    'fc_weight',
    TensorProto.FLOAT,
    fc_weight.shape,
    fc_weight.flatten()
)

# Create nodes
conv_node = helper.make_node(

```

```

'Conv',
inputs=['input', 'conv_weight'],
outputs=['conv_output'],
kernel_shape=[7, 7],
strides=[2, 2],
pads=[3, 3, 3, 3]
)

relu_node = helper.make_node(
'Relu',
inputs=['conv_output'],
outputs=['relu_output']
)

pool_node = helper.make_node(
'GlobalAveragePool',
inputs=['relu_output'],
outputs=['pool_output']
)

flatten_node = helper.make_node(
'Flatten',
inputs=['pool_output'],
outputs=['flatten_output']
)

fc_node = helper.make_node(
'MatMul',
inputs=['flatten_output', 'fc_weight'],
outputs=['output']
)

# Create graph
graph = helper.make_graph(
nodes=[conv_node, relu_node, pool_node, flatten_node, fc_node],
name='simple_cnn',
inputs=[input_info],
outputs=[output_info],
initializer=[conv_weight_tensor, fc_weight_tensor]
)

# Create model
model = helper.make_model(graph, producer_name='custom_builder')
model.opset_import[0].version = 15

# Check and save
onnx.checker.check_model(model)
onnx.save(model, 'custom_model.onnx')
print("Model created successfully!")

```

### 1.7.3 Example 3: Model Inspection

**Inspecting ONNX Model** (actual code):

```

import onnx

# Load model
model = onnx.load("model.onnx")

# Print basic info
print(f"IR Version: {model.ir_version}")
print(f"Producer: {model.producer_name} {model.producer_version}")
print(f"Opset Version: {model.opset_import[0].version}")

# Graph info
graph = model.graph
print(f"nGraph Name: {graph.name}")
print(f"Number of Nodes: {len(graph.node)}")
print(f"Number of Initializers: {len(graph.initializer)}")

# Input/Output shapes
print("nInputs:")
for input_tensor in graph.input:
    print(f" {input_tensor.name}: {[d.dim_value or d.dim_param for d in input_tensor.type.tensor_type.shape.dim]}")

print("nOutputs:")
for output_tensor in graph.output:
    print(f" {output_tensor.name}: {[d.dim_value or d.dim_param for d in output_tensor.type.tensor_type.shape.dim]}")

# Node details
print("nNodes:")
for node in graph.node:
    print(f" {node.op_type}: {node.input} -> {node.output}")
    if node.attribute:
        for attr in node.attribute:
            print(f" {attr.name}: {onnx.helper.get_attribute_value(attr)}")

```

### 1.7.4 Example 4: ONNX Runtime Inference (Production)

**Optimized Inference** (actual code):

```

import onnxruntime as ort
import numpy as np

class ONNXInferenceEngine:
    def __init__(self, model_path, use_gpu=False):
        # Set execution providers
        providers = ['CUDAExecutionProvider', 'CPUExecutionProvider'] if use_gpu else ['CPUExecutionProvider']

        # Create session with options
        sess_options = ort.SessionOptions()
        sess_options.graph_optimization_level = ort.GraphOptimizationLevel.ORT_ENABLE_ALL
        sess_options.intra_op_num_threads = 4

        self.session = ort.InferenceSession(
            model_path,
            sess_options=sess_options,
            providers=providers
        )

        # Get input/output metadata
        self.input_name = self.session.get_inputs()[0].name
        self.output_name = self.session.get_outputs()[0].name
        self.input_shape = self.session.get_inputs()[0].shape

    def predict(self, input_data):
        """Run inference on input data"""
        # Ensure correct dtype
        if not isinstance(input_data, np.ndarray):
            input_data = np.array(input_data)
        if input_data.dtype != np.float32:
            input_data = input_data.astype(np.float32)

        # Run inference
        outputs = self.session.run(
            [self.output_name],
            {self.input_name: input_data}
        )

        return outputs[0]

    def batch_predict(self, batch_data, batch_size=32):
        """Efficient batch inference"""
        results = []
        for i in range(0, len(batch_data), batch_size):
            batch = batch_data[i:i+batch_size]
            batch_array = np.array(batch, dtype=np.float32)
            output = self.predict(batch_array)
            results.append(output)
        return np.concatenate(results, axis=0)

# Usage
engine = ONNXInferenceEngine("model.onnx", use_gpu=True)

# Single inference
input_data = np.random.randn(1, 3, 224, 224).astype(np.float32)
prediction = engine.predict(input_data)
print(f"Prediction shape: {prediction.shape}")

# Batch inference
batch_data = [np.random.randn(3, 224, 224) for _ in range(100)]
batch_predictions = engine.batch_predict(batch_data, batch_size=16)
print(f"Batch predictions shape: {batch_predictions.shape}")

```

## 1.8 Tools & Ecosystem

### 1.8.1 Model Conversion Tools

| Tool                        | Description                       | Homepage                                                                                          |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>PyTorch</b>              | Native ONNX export via torch.onnx | <a href="https://pytorch.org/docs/stable/onnx.html">https://pytorch.org/docs/stable/onnx.html</a> |
| <b>TensorFlow (tf2onnx)</b> | TF/Keras to ONNX converter        | <a href="https://github.com/onnx/tensorflow-onnx">https://github.com/onnx/tensorflow-onnx</a>     |
| <b>ONNX-TensorFlow</b>      | Bi-directional TF↔ONNX            | <a href="https://github.com/onnx/onnx-tensorflow">https://github.com/onnx/onnx-tensorflow</a>     |
| <b>sklearn-onnx</b>         | Scikit-learn to ONNX              | <a href="https://github.com/onnx/sklearn-onnx">https://github.com/onnx/sklearn-onnx</a>           |
| <b>CoreML Tools</b>         | CoreML↔ONNX conversion            | <a href="https://github.com/apple/coremltools">https://github.com/apple/coremltools</a>           |
| <b>Keras2onnx</b>           | Keras to ONNX                     | <a href="https://github.com/onnx/keras-onnx">https://github.com/onnx/keras-onnx</a>               |

### 1.8.2 Runtime & Inference

| Tool                | Description                                 | Homepage                                                                                  |
|---------------------|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>ONNX Runtime</b> | Microsoft's cross-platform inference engine | <a href="https://onnxruntime.ai/">https://onnxruntime.ai/</a>                             |
| <b>TensorRT</b>     | NVIDIA's high-performance inference         | <a href="https://developer.nvidia.com/tensorrt">https://developer.nvidia.com/tensorrt</a> |
| <b>OpenVINO</b>     | Intel's inference toolkit                   | <a href="https://docs.openvino.ai/">https://docs.openvino.ai/</a>                         |
| <b>ONNX.js</b>      | Browser-based inference                     | <a href="https://github.com/microsoft/onnxjs">https://github.com/microsoft/onnxjs</a>     |
| <b>MXNet</b>        | Apache MXNet with ONNX support              | <a href="https://mxnet.apache.org/">https://mxnet.apache.org/</a>                         |

### 1.8.3 Optimization & Validation

| Tool                   | Description                 | Homepage                                                                                                |
|------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>ONNX Optimizer</b>  | Graph optimization passes   | <a href="https://github.com/onnx/optimizer">https://github.com/onnx/optimizer</a>                       |
| <b>ONNX Simplifier</b> | Simplify ONNX models        | <a href="https://github.com/daquexian/onnx-simplifier">https://github.com/daquexian/onnx-simplifier</a> |
| <b>Netron</b>          | Neural network visualizer   | <a href="https://netron.app/">https://netron.app/</a>                                                   |
| <b>ONNX Checker</b>    | Model validation (built-in) | Part of ONNX package                                                                                    |

### 1.8.4 Model Repositories

| Repository              | Description                  | Homepage                                                                    |
|-------------------------|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>ONNX Model Zoo</b>   | Official pre-trained models  | <a href="https://github.com/onnx/models">https://github.com/onnx/models</a> |
| <b>Hugging Face Hub</b> | Community models (many ONNX) | <a href="https://huggingface.co/models">https://huggingface.co/models</a>   |
| <b>ONNX Model Hub</b>   | Curated model collection     | <a href="https://onnx.ai/models">https://onnx.ai/models</a>                 |

## 1.9 Best Practices

### 1.9.1 1. Version Management

```
# Always specify opset version explicitly
torch.onnx.export(
    model,
    dummy_input,
    "model.onnx",
    opset_version=15 # Use latest stable opset
)
```

### 1.9.2 2. Dynamic Shapes

```
# Enable dynamic batch size for flexibility
dynamic_axes = {
    'input': {0: 'batch_size'},
    'output': {0: 'batch_size'}
}

torch.onnx.export(
    model, dummy_input, "model.onnx",
    dynamic_axes=dynamic_axes
)
```

### 1.9.3 3. Model Validation

```
import onnx

# Always validate after export
model = onnx.load("model.onnx")
onnx.checker.check_model(model)

# Check for potential issues
from onnx import shape_inference
inferred_model = shape_inference.infer_shapes(model)
```

### 1.9.4 4. Performance Testing

```
import time
import numpy as np

# Benchmark inference
def benchmark(session, input_data, num_runs=100):
    # Warmup
    for _ in range(10):
        session.run(None, {session.get_inputs()[0].name: input_data})

    # Measure
    start = time.time()
    for _ in range(num_runs):
        session.run(None, {session.get_inputs()[0].name: input_data})
    end = time.time()

    avg_time = (end - start) / num_runs * 1000 #ms
    print(f"Average inference time: {avg_time:.2f} ms")

session = ort.InferenceSession("model.onnx")
input_data = np.random.randn(1, 3, 224, 224).astype(np.float32)
benchmark(session, input_data)
```

### 1.9.5 5. Metadata Management

```
# Add model metadata
model.metadata_props.append(
    onnx.StringStringEntryProto(key="description", value="Image classifier")
)
model.metadata_props.append(
    onnx.StringStringEntryProto(key="author", value="ML Team")
)
model.metadata_props.append(
    onnx.StringStringEntryProto(key="license", value="Apache-2.0")
)
```

---

## 1.10 References

### 1.10.1 Official Documentation

- ONNX GitHub: <https://github.com/onnx/onnx>
- ONNX Tutorials: <https://github.com/onnx/tutorials>
- ONNX Runtime Docs: <https://onnxruntime.ai/docs/>

### 1.10.2 Related Standards

- **Protocol Buffers**: <https://protobuf.dev/>
- **Model Cards**: See [04-Model-Cards.md](#)
- **Vector Embeddings**: See [A01-Vector-Embeddings-Standards.md](#)

### 1.10.3 Community Resources

- ONNX Slack: <https://lfaifoundation.slack.com/>
- ONNX Working Groups: <https://github.com/onnx/onnx/blob/main/community/readme.md>

---

**Navigation:** [Back to Index](#) | [Previous: Neural Networks Fundamentals](#) | [Next: OpenAPI for AI Services](#)